UX WRITING & RESEARCH · CASE STUDY

LegalEase

Motolani Deborah Akinyemi

> **Project:** LegalEase (In Progress)
> **Role:** UX Research Analyst & UX Writer
> **Focus:** Access to Legal Aid for Everyday Nigerians via a Mobile App
> **Client:** Collaborative Startup (Confidential)

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

LegalEase is a mobile-first legal tech solution targeting a dual user base: underserved everyday Nigerians who require simplified access to justice, and aspiring legal professionals (particularly students) in search of structured, real-life experience.

The platform aims to bridge access to justice by creating a collaborative legal ecosystem—driven by intuitive UX, conversational writing, and culturally relevant digital architecture.

I was hired as the UX Research Analyst and UX Writer to lead the foundational design strategy, uncover and interpret user pain points, develop a linguistic ecosystem for legal communication, and deliver a compelling product roadmap backed by evidence-based insights.

PROBLEM STATEMENT

Nigeria has an access-to-justice problem. Millions of citizens are unaware of their rights, legal processes, or how to get help without excessive cost. Legalese is not just confusing—it is alienating. On the flip side, law students struggle to engage with real clients before graduation, while many legal professionals want to give back but lack structured pathways for pro bono involvement.

- LegalEase aims to:
- Demystify Nigerian laws through plain language and engaging digital content
- Connect users to volunteer lawyers for pro bono work
- Support legal literacy with accessible resources
- Provide opportunities for law students to gain experience under supervision
- Offer a structured, ethical framework for collaboration between lawyers, students, and

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

Primary Research Tools Used:

- User interviews (remote + in-person)
- Contextual inquiries (courtrooms, law clinics)
- Survey (via Google Forms)
- Stakeholder roundtable (3 lawyers, 2 product advisors, 1 NGO lead)
- Desk research (legal tech trends, literacy rates, UX in African contexts)

Key Personas Developed:

- Everyday User (Age 24-45): Low-income, limited legal knowledge
- Law Student: Year 3-5 student, seeking real casework exposure
- Legal Volunteer: Mid-career barrister offering pro bono service

USER INSIGHT SNAPSHOT

Survey Data:

Issue % of Respondents Affected

Don't know where to start when facing a legal issue 78%

Have been cheated but did nothing 62%

Want legal help but fear the cost 85%

Can't understand legal documents 74%

Direct Quotes:

> *"My landlord took my property and I didn’t know if I had a right to report."*

"I study law but I’ve never helped a real person. It’s all theory."

"Even free legal clinics are too far or full. We need something easy, something mobile."
COMPETITIVE ANALYSIS

Platform Limitation

LawPadi Not mobile-first, lacks chat UI

LegalNaija Blog-style; lacks interactivity

PocketLawyer (US) Not localized to Nigerian context

DESIGN STRATEGY

Brand Attributes:

- Voice: Calm, respectful, supportive
- Tone: Clear, hopeful, professional (not cold)
- Personality: Like a community lawyer that listens before advising

Proposed Color Scheme (Accessible + Trustworthy):

- Primary: Deep Indigo (#283593) – stability, trust
- Accent: Mint Green (#A5D6A7) – freshness, approachability
- Neutral: Ivory (#FAFAFA) and Charcoal (#424242)

Typography System:

- Headlines: DM Serif Display – evokes trust, classic law aesthetics
- Body Text: Inter or IBM Plex Sans – clean, modern readability
- Buttons/Microcopy: Poppins – strong yet friendly

Iconography:

- Thin-line outline icons (filled on interaction)
- Icons for Law, Chat, People, Calendar, Info

Accessibility:

- All touch targets 48px+
- Text size min 16px
- ARIA-labels and screen reader tagging on forms CORE FEATURES & FLOW

1. Conversational Legal Guidance (Chat-First UI):

- Users are onboarded via a quick question prompt: "What legal issue do you need help with?"
- Keywords (e.g. landlord, police, divorce) trigger microflows with simplified Q&A and legal literacy content

2. Ask-A-Lawyer (Volunteer-Driven):

- Anonymous legal questions answered by pre-vetted pro bono lawyers
- Moderated by legal students under supervision

3. Case Intake & Matching:

- Users can submit a form with details; the system suggests available lawyers nearby
- Lawyers choose based on specialization, availability

4. Legal Learn Cards (Plain Language Modules):

- Micro-courses on topics like:
- How to respond to a court summons
- What to do if arrested
- Understanding child custody
- Written in Pidgin and English with visual metaphors

5. Court Companion Tool:

- Track court dates, get reminders, see simplified definitions for hearing types, legal docs

6. Student Portal:

- Connect students to real-life mentorships
- Case study contribution system
- Certificate and review system from supervisors

SAMPLE MICROCOPY

UI Element Before After

Error Message Invalid input Hmm, we didn’t catch that. Want to try again?

Court Reminder You have a court Court dey come o! Na your case about date. house matter.

Legal Term Adjournment Adjournment: when your case is moved to another day. LOW-FI WIREFRAMES & FLOW DIAGRAMS

- Flow 1: First-Time User → Needs Help → Chat Intake → Q&A → Learn Card → Lawyer Match
- Flow 2: Student Sign Up → Choose Topics → Get Matched → Submit Reflections

RISK ASSESSMENT

Risk Proposed Mitigation

Legal liability Disclaimers + all lawyers vetted/licensed

Misinformation Content created with legal NGO partners

Low lawyer participation Gamify hours; highlight top contributors

KPIs & METRICS TO TRACK

- Legal literacy module completion rate
- Chat flow drop-off rate
- Lawyer-volunteer response time
- Number of resolved cases
- User satisfaction rating (emoji system + star reviews)

STRATEGIC RECOMMENDATIONS

- Brand Messaging Guide: Use user-friendly language as part of your product DNA, not just content
- Design Sprint: Prioritize onboarding + first chat experience as MVP
- Pilot Program: Begin with 3 states (Lagos, Abuja, Port Harcourt)
- Partner Early: With universities (law faculties) and NGOs

NEXT STEPS

1. Finalize interactive prototype

2. Conduct user testing (Round 2: 20 users)

3. Develop microcopy style guide

4. Prep investor-facing pitch deck (copy + visuals)

5. Begin outreach to legal associations for contribution pipeline Curtains

LegalEase isn’t just a legal app—it’s a civic movement in UX form. It meets people where they are: on their phones, in need, and uncertain. As the UX research and writing lead, I’ve made it my mission to ensure that language becomes a bridge, not a barrier, in the pursuit of justice.

Let’s build a justice system that doesn’t just exist—but serves.